

Notification Framework



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Guides

Upload and attach media files to email and WhatsApp

Upload files to Notification Framework and reference them by `file_id` in notification content, with automatic URL signing and expiry management.

The media API lets you upload files once and attach them to email or WhatsApp notifications by reference. The platform handles URL signing, token management, and expiry renewal — you only need to store the `file_id` returned at upload time. This keeps your `POST /notify` payloads small and avoids base64 encoding overhead.

1 Upload a file

Send a `POST /media/upload` request as `multipart/form-data` with your file and `client_id`:

```
curl -X POST https://your-api/media/upload \  
  -H "X-API-Key: nf_your_key" \  
  -F "file=@invoice.pdf" \  
  -F "client_id=client_abc123"
```

The response includes all fields you need to reference the file later:

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>

```
"mime_type": "application/pdf",
"size_bytes": 204800,
"delivery_mode": "auto",
"expires_at": "2026-06-04T12:00:00",
"storage": "local_file"
}
```

Response field	Description
<code>file_id</code>	Stable identifier. Use this in notification content.
<code>url</code>	Signed URL for direct access. Includes a token query parameter.
<code>original_name</code>	Original filename as uploaded.
<code>mime_type</code>	Detected or inferred MIME type.
<code>size_bytes</code>	File size in bytes.
<code>expires_at</code>	When the signed URL expires (default: 30 days).

ⓘ The maximum upload size is 250 MB by default. This is configurable via the `MEDIA_UPLOAD_MAX_MB` environment variable.

2 Reference the file in a notification

Use the `file_id` in the `attachments` array of your notification `content`. The platform resolves the signed URL at dispatch time:

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```
>  
  
    "attachments": [  
      {  
        "file_id": "mf_a1b2c3d4e5f6",  
        "name": "invoice.pdf",  
        "delivery_mode": "attach"  
      }  
    ]  
  }  
}
```

The `delivery_mode` field controls how the attachment is included:

Value	Behavior
"attach"	Embed the file directly in the email.
"link_only"	Send as a download link instead of embedding.
omitted	Automatic: files over 20 MB become links; smaller files are attached.

3 Retrieve a file

Fetch a file by `file_id` using the signed token from the upload response:

```
GET /media/{file_id}?token=your_token
```

Authenticated requests (using `X-API-Key` with the owning client) can access files without the token. External providers such as SendGrid or UltraMsg use the tokenized URL directly.

WhatsApp attachments

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Private or localhost URLs (e.g. `127.0.0.1`, `172.168.X.X`, `.local` domains) will cause WhatsApp delivery to fail. Set the `PUBLIC_BASE_URL` environment variable to a public HTTPS host — for example, an ngrok URL — before using locally uploaded files as WhatsApp attachments.

URL expiry and token rotation

File URLs expire after 30 days by default (configurable via `MEDIA_URL_TTL_DAYS`). The platform automatically rotates tokens when a job is retried or replayed from the dead-letter queue, so expired URLs do not permanently block delivery. The `file_id` remains stable across token rotations.

⚠ Store the `file_id`, not the signed URL. The signed URL will expire; the `file_id` is permanent for the lifetime of the file.

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